

ITIL 4 Foundation

A Scenario-Focused Study Guide — built to think, not just memorise



Focus indicators on every topic



Scenario & multi-answer practice



Visual diagrams & memory hooks

Prepared for scenario-based examination • Current scheme: **ITIL 4**

Legacy ITIL V3 content is kept only as background context.

How to Use This Guide

Your exam is **scenario-based**: you'll be given a situation and asked which actions, principles, or practices apply — and **more than two options can be correct**. Pure memorisation won't be enough. This guide is built to train *judgement*: each concept ends with "how it shows up in a scenario," and there's a large applied question bank at the end.

The Focus System — where to spend your energy

EXAM CRITICAL



Heavily tested and always scenario-applied. **Master completely.** (Guiding Principles, Service Value Chain, key practices, core value concepts.)

IMPORTANT



Frequently tested. Know definitions **and** when they apply.

GOOD TO KNOW



Supports understanding; appears in mixed questions.

CONTEXT (V3)



ITIL V3 — **not directly examined**. Read once for comparison, don't over-study.

Reality check on your notes: Roughly half of your notes cover **ITIL V3** (lifecycle, 26 processes, 4 functions, Four Ps, certification levels). ITIL V3 was retired in 2022. The exam tests **ITIL 4**. In this guide, V3 sections are marked **CONTEXT (V3)** — understand them, but put your real effort into the **EXAM CRITICAL** ITIL 4 sections.

Exam format (quick facts)

Item	Detail
Questions	40 multiple choice
Duration	60 minutes
Pass mark	26 / 40 = 65%
Style	Standard, negative ("which is NOT"), list ("select all that apply"), and missing-word

Contents

1	Core Concepts: Value, Service, Outcomes & Risk	CRITICAL	the foundation
2	Stakeholders & the Service Relationship	IMPORTANT	who's who
3	The 7 Guiding Principles	CRITICAL	most scenario weight
4	The Four Dimensions	IMPORTANT	holistic view
5	Service Value System (SVS)	IMPORTANT	the big picture
6	Service Value Chain	CRITICAL	6 activities
7	Continual Improvement Model	IMPORTANT	7 steps
8	The 15 Practices	CRITICAL	know the top ones cold
9	Key Terminology (Incident/Problem/Change...)	CRITICAL	definitions that decide answers
10	ITIL V3 Background	CONTEXT	read once
11	Scenario Question Bank (multi-answer)	CRITICAL	train here
12	Rapid Revision Sheet		last-hour cram

1 Core Concepts EXAM CRITICAL 🔥🔥🔥

Scenario questions constantly hinge on these words. If you can tell **output** from **outcome** and **utility** from **warranty**, you'll answer a surprising number of questions correctly.



Value CRITICAL

The **perceived benefits, usefulness and importance** of something. Key word: **perceived** — value is subjective and defined by the **consumer**, not the provider. It is **co-created** through active collaboration (ITIL 4's central idea).

Service

A means of enabling value co-creation by facilitating **outcomes** customers want, **without the customer having to manage specific costs and risks**.

Output vs Outcome — the classic trap

Output

A tangible/intangible **deliverable** produced by an activity.

e.g. a monthly report is generated

vs

Outcome

A **result** for a stakeholder, **enabled** by outputs.

e.g. the manager makes a confident budget decision

Memory: Output = *what* was produced. Outcome = *why it mattered*. Customers don't want the drill (output); they want the hole — and really, a picture on the wall (outcome).

Cost & Risk — the two sides a service removes/adds

Term	Removed by the service (good)	Imposed by the service (to weigh)
Costs	Costs the consumer no longer bears (e.g. buying servers)	Costs the consumer takes on (e.g. subscription fee)
Risks	Risks removed from the consumer (e.g. hardware failure)	New risks the service introduces (e.g. outage, vendor lock-in)

Utility & Warranty CRITICAL — often paired in scenarios

Utility = Fit for PURPOSE

What the service *does*; does it meet a need / support performance or remove a constraint?

The "what."

Warranty = Fit for USE

How the service *performs*: availability, capacity, security, continuity — meeting agreed requirements.

The "how well."

Scenario cue: Both are needed for value. "Feature works but keeps crashing" = utility ✓ / warranty ✗.
"Reliable but doesn't do what we need" = warranty ✓ / utility ✗.



Micro-scenario

A payroll app processes salaries correctly but is unavailable every Friday afternoon when staff need it. Which statements are true? (select all that apply)

A. The service provides utility.

B. The service lacks adequate warranty.

C. Value is fully delivered because payroll is accurate.

D. Availability is a warranty concern.

Correct: A, B, D. Utility (does the job) is present; the Friday unavailability is a warranty failure, and availability is a warranty characteristic. **C is wrong** — value needs both utility *and* warranty.

2 Stakeholders & Service Relationships IMPORTANT 🔥🔥



The Consumer's three roles CRITICAL

Role	Does what	Scenario keyword
Customer	Defines requirements & is accountable for outcomes	"decides what is needed"
User	Actually uses the service day to day	"logs in / uses / raises tickets"
Sponsor	Authorises the budget	"approves spend / funds it"

Memory: Customer = **C**hooses, Sponsor = **\$**pays, User = **U**ses. One person can hold several roles in a small company.

ITIL 4 shift: value is **co-created** — the provider does *not* create value alone and hand it over. Consumers, suppliers and partners all contribute.

Provider ↔ Consumer both give and get

A service relationship is **collaborative**: the provider supplies the service; the consumer contributes requirements, resources, feedback and correct usage. Poor consumer behaviour (e.g. ignoring guidance) reduces value — a common scenario theme.

Micro-scenario

An IT manager specifies a new collaboration tool, the finance director signs off the annual licence cost, and 300 employees use it daily. Match the roles.

A. IT manager = Customer

B. Finance director = Sponsor

C. Employees = Users

D. IT manager = Sponsor

Correct: A, B, C. D is wrong — the sponsor is whoever authorises funding (the finance director).

3 The 7 Guiding Principles EXAM CRITICAL 🔥🔥🔥

Highest scenario weight in the whole exam. You must recognise a principle from a described situation — not just recite the list. Expect "which **two/three** principles apply?"

1. Focus on value

Everything must link to value for a stakeholder. First and lens for all others.

Cue: "why are we doing this? who benefits?"

2. Start where you are

Don't rip & replace. Assess & reuse what exists; measure before you judge.

Cue: "we assumed... but should check current state."

3. Progress iteratively with feedback

Small manageable steps; use feedback loops each iteration.

Cue: "big bang" is bad; "pilot / phase / review."

4. Collaborate & promote visibility

Right people involved; work made visible; reduce silos & hidden work.

Cue: "no one knew / worked in isolation."

5. Think & work holistically

The service is a whole system (all 4 dimensions); no isolated changes.

Cue: "changed one part, broke another."

6. Keep it simple & practical

Minimum steps to achieve the outcome; remove what adds no value.

Cue: "process has 12 approvals no one uses."

7. Optimize & automate

Optimize first, then automate. Don't automate a broken process. Human intervention where it truly adds value.

Cue: "automated the mess" = wrong order; optimise, then automate.

Memory sentence: "Focus Starts Progress, Collaboration Thinks, Keep Optimising." → Value, Start, Iterate, Collaborate, Holistic, Simple, Automate.

Common distinctions the exam exploits:

- **Start where you are** = look at the *current/existing* state. **Focus on value** = link to benefit.
- **Iteratively + feedback** = small steps *with review*. **Collaborate + visibility** = people + transparency.
- **Optimize & automate** — remember the **order**; automating without optimising is the classic wrong answer.



Scenario (multi-answer)

A team wants to improve incident handling. They plan to automate the entire workflow immediately, without reviewing the current process, and only two engineers know the plan. Which principles are being **violated**?

(select all that apply)

A. Optimize and automate

B. Start where you are

C. Collaborate and promote visibility

D. Focus on value

Correct: A, B, C. Automating before optimising violates (A); skipping review of the current process violates (B); keeping the plan to two people violates (C). D isn't clearly violated — improving incidents can still target value.

4 The Four Dimensions of Service Management IMPORTANT 🔥🔥

All four must be considered for **every** service to deliver value — ignore one and quality suffers. They are surrounded by **external (PESTLE) factors**: Political, Economic, Social, Technological, Legal, Environmental.

1. Organizations & People — *Who?*

Structures, roles, skills, culture, communication, staffing.

2. Information & Technology — *What with?*

Info, knowledge, tools, apps, databases; security & compliance.

3. Partners & Suppliers — *Who helps?*

Vendors, contracts, outsourcing, integration of external services.

4. Value Streams & Processes — *How?*

The activities, workflows and coordination that create value.

Map to the old Four Ps: People→Org&People, Products→Info&Tech, Partners→Partners&Suppliers, Processes→Value Streams&Processes. And **PESTLE** wraps around all four.



Scenario (multi-answer)

A new GDPR law forces changes to how customer data is stored, requires staff retraining, and means renegotiating a cloud contract. Which dimensions are affected? (select all that apply)

A. Information & Technology (data storage)

B. Organizations & People (retraining)

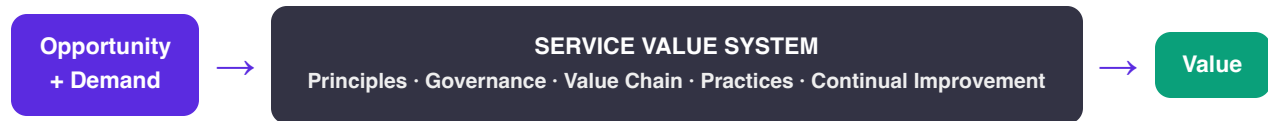
C. Partners & Suppliers (cloud contract)

D. None — this is only an external factor

Correct: A, B, C. The **Legal** PESTLE factor *triggers* impacts across three dimensions. D is wrong: external factors act *through* the dimensions.

5 Service Value System (SVS) IMPORTANT 🔥🔥

Describes how **all components and activities work together** to enable value. **Input:** Opportunity & Demand → **SVS** → **Output:** Value.



The 5 components

Component	Purpose
Guiding Principles	Recommendations that guide decisions in any circumstance
Governance	How the organisation is directed and controlled
Service Value Chain	The operating model — 6 activities that create/deliver value
Practices	Sets of organisational resources for doing work (the 34 practices)
Continual Improvement	Recurring improvement at all levels

Memory: “G-G-V-P-C” — Guiding principles, Governance, Value chain, Practices, Continual improvement.

Purpose of the SVS: to ensure the organisation **continually co-creates value** and to counter **silos** and rigid working.

6 Service Value Chain (SVC) EXAM CRITICAL 🔥🔥🔥

The core of the SVS — an **operating model** of 6 activities. It is **not** a fixed sequence: activities combine into many **value streams**. Each activity uses practices and can call any other activity.



Activity	Purpose	Scenario cue
Plan	Shared vision, direction, policies for all four dimensions	strategy, direction, portfolio
Improve	Continual improvement across products, services, practices	"make it better over time"
Engage 	Understand needs; good relationships with all stakeholders	"talk to customers/suppliers/users"
Design & Transition	Meet expectations for quality, cost, time-to-market; release into use	"design + move to live"
Obtain / Build	Ensure components are available when & where needed, to spec	"build or buy components"
Deliver & Support	Deliver services to agreed specs; ongoing support	"run + support live service"

Memory "PI-E-D-O-D": Plan, Improve, Engage, Design&Transition, Obtain/Build, Deliver&Support. **Engage** is the newest emphasis — stakeholder-facing.

Key exam point: the SVC is **flexible**, not linear. A value stream (e.g. resolving a user request) may hit Engage → Deliver&Support → Obtain/Build → Deliver&Support in any needed order.



Scenario (multi-answer)

A user reports a broken feature. The service desk gathers details, an engineer builds a fix, and it's released and confirmed with the user. Which value chain activities are clearly involved? (select all that apply)

A. Engage (capturing the report & confirming with user)

B. Obtain/Build (building the fix)

C. Deliver & Support (resolving and supporting)

D. Plan (setting the 5-year strategy)

Correct: A, B, C. D (Plan) is about direction/strategy, not this operational request. Note how several activities combine in one value stream.

7 Continual Improvement Model IMPORTANT 🔥🔥

A structured, repeatable path for improvement at any level. Expect scenario questions asking **which step is being skipped or performed**.



Links to remember: Step 2 ("where are we now?") applies the guiding principle **Start where you are**. The whole model is powered by the **Improve** value-chain activity and the **Continual Improvement** practice. A **baseline** is the measured starting point used to judge progress.



Scenario

A team jumps straight from "we want faster deployments" to buying a tool, never measuring current deployment time. Which steps did they skip? (select all that apply)

A. Where are we now? (no baseline)

B. Where do we want to be? (no measurable target)

C. Did we get there? (can't measure without a baseline)

D. Take action

Correct: A, B, C. They took action (D), but with no baseline (A), no defined target (B), and therefore no way to verify success (C).

8 The 15 Foundation Practices EXAM CRITICAL 🔥🔥🔥

ITIL 4 has 34 practices; **15** are examinable, and **7** of those are described in more depth. A **practice** = a set of organisational resources (people, process, tech, information) for performing work — **broader than a V3 "process."**

The 7 deep-dive practices — know these cold CRITICAL

Practice	Purpose	Scenario trigger
Incident Management	Restore normal service ASAP , minimise impact	"service down / degraded — fix fast"
Problem Management	Reduce likelihood/impact by finding root cause ; manage known errors	"why does this keep happening?"
Service Request Mgmt	Handle pre-defined, normal user requests smoothly	"password reset, new laptop, access"
Service Desk	Single point of contact ; capture demand, empathy, communication	"first point of contact"
Change Enablement	Maximise successful changes; balance risk, benefit, speed	"assess/authorise a change"
Service Level Mgmt	Set clear, business-based targets (SLAs) ; monitor & report	"are we meeting agreed levels?"
Continual Improvement	Align practices/services with changing needs; ongoing betterment	"keep improving"

The other 8 examinable practices IMPORTANT

Practice	Purpose (one line)
Information Security Mgmt	Protect Confidentiality, Integrity, Availability (CIA)
Relationship Management	Nurture links with all stakeholders
Supplier Management	Ensure suppliers/contracts deliver quality
IT Asset Management	Plan & manage the full lifecycle of IT assets (financial value)
Monitoring & Event Mgmt	Observe services; detect & categorise events ; respond
Release Management	Make new/changed features available for use (plan the release)
Service Configuration Mgmt	Accurate info on configuration items (CIs) & their relationships
Deployment Management	Move new/changed components into live environments

Distinctions the exam loves

Incident vs Problem

Incident = restore service *fast* (symptom). Problem = find/remove *root cause*. A **known error** = analysed problem, fix pending; a **workaround** reduces impact meanwhile.

Release vs Deployment

Release = making features *available for use* (the plan/decision). Deployment = the technical *move into an environment*. They can happen at different times.

Service Request vs Incident

Request = normal, pre-approved (a new phone).
Incident = something is broken/degraded. Don't treat a request as an incident.

Change Enablement vs Deployment

Change Enablement = *authorise/assess* the change.
Deployment = *technically perform* it. Not every deployment is a "change" record, and vice-versa.

Change types (Change Enablement) **IMPORTANT**

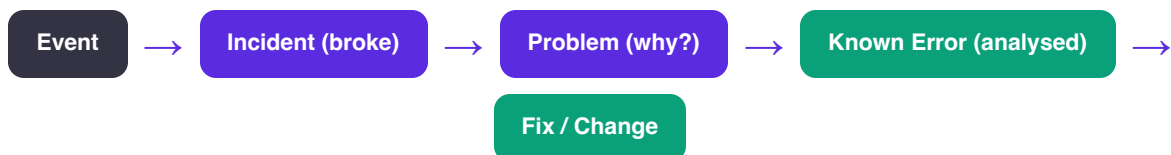
Type	Meaning	Authorised by
Standard	Low-risk, pre-authorised, repeatable (follows a procedure)	Pre-authorised (no separate approval each time)
Normal	Assessed, scheduled & authorised via the normal flow	Change authority (role, not always a "CAB")
Emergency	Must be implemented ASAP (e.g. security fix)	Expedited authority / emergency process

Note: ITIL 4 talks about a **change authority** (which may be a person/role), moving away from a heavyweight CAB for every change — supports "keep it simple" and fast, safe flow.

9 Key Terminology EXAM CRITICAL 🔥🔥🔥

These definitions frequently **decide** the correct answer in a scenario. Learn them precisely.

Term	Precise definition
Event	Any change of state significant for the management of a service/CI.
Incident	An unplanned interruption or reduction in quality of a service.
Problem	A cause , or potential cause, of one or more incidents.
Known error	A problem that has been analysed but not resolved .
Workaround	A solution that reduces/eliminates impact of an incident/problem without a full fix.
Change	Addition, modification or removal of anything that could affect services .
Configuration Item (CI)	Any component that must be managed to deliver a service.
IT Asset	Any valuable component that can contribute to service delivery (has financial value).
Service Request	A request from a user for something normal & pre-defined .
Service Level (SLA)	A documented, measurable target for a service, agreed with the customer.
Baseline	A recorded snapshot used as a reference point for comparison.
Cost / Risk	Cost = money for an activity; Risk = possible event causing harm or preventing objectives.





Scenario (multi-answer)

Monitoring flags a disk at 95%. It doesn't disrupt users yet, but 20 minutes later the app slows and users complain. Engineers apply a temporary script to free space while investigating the recurring cause. Which statements are correct? (select all that apply)

A. The 95% alert is an **event**.

B. The user-facing slowdown is an **incident**.

C. The temporary script is a **workaround**.

D. Investigating the recurring cause is **problem management**.

E. The 95% alert is itself an incident.

Correct: A, B, C, D. E is wrong — an event is only a change of state; it becomes an incident when service is interrupted/degraded (the slowdown).

10 ITIL V3 Background

CONTEXT ONLY — don't over-study

Do not memorise this for the exam. ITIL 4 replaced these structures. Read once so you recognise the mapping if a question references older terms.

Four Ps (Service Design)

People · Processes · Products · Partners
→ became the **Four Dimensions**

Service Lifecycle (5 stages)

Strategy → Design → Transition → Operation → CSI
→ became the **Service Value Chain**

ITIL V3	ITIL 4 equivalent
26 Processes + 4 Functions	34 Practices (no separate "functions")
Service Lifecycle	Service Value System + Service Value Chain
Four Ps	Four Dimensions (+ PESTLE)
Change Management	Change Enablement
Request Fulfilment	Service Request Management
Value delivered by provider	Value co-created
RACI, Process Owner/Manager roles	Not defined at Foundation level

V3 functions (Service Desk, Technical/Application/IT Ops Management) and the 5 certification levels (Foundation→Master) are legacy. Only **Service Desk** survives as an ITIL 4 *practice*.

11 Scenario Question Bank TRAIN HERE 🔥🔥🔥

Answer **before** reading the explanation. Several have **3+ correct options**, exactly like your exam.

Q1 · Guiding Principles

A company inherits a messy but working CMDB. Leadership wants to scrap it and build a "perfect" new one from scratch, in one big project, with a small secret team. As an adviser, which principles would you invoke to challenge this plan? (select all that apply)

- ☐ A. Start where you are
- ☐ B. Progress iteratively with feedback
- ☐ C. Collaborate and promote visibility
- ☐ D. Keep it simple and practical

Correct: A, B, C, D. Scrapping a working asset ignores **Start where you are**; a "big bang" ignores **iterate with feedback**; a secret team ignores **collaborate/visibility**; chasing "perfect" ignores **keep it simple**.

Q2 · Incident vs Problem vs Change

An outage is restored by rebooting a server. Users are back in 10 minutes. The team then opens an investigation into why the server keeps failing weekly and plans a permanent fix requiring a scheduled change. Which are correct? (select all that apply)

- ☐ A. Restoring service quickly is Incident Management.
- ☐ B. Investigating the weekly failure is Problem Management.
- ☐ C. The permanent fix will go through Change Enablement.
- ☐ D. The reboot was Problem Management because it fixed the issue.

Correct: A, B, C. D is wrong — the reboot only *restored* service (incident), it didn't remove the root cause.

Q3 · Four Dimensions

A migration to a new cloud provider requires updated security tooling, staff certification, a new support contract, and redesigned deployment workflows. Which dimensions are engaged? (select all that apply)

A. Information & Technology

B. Organizations & People

C. Partners & Suppliers

D. Value Streams & Processes

Correct: A, B, C, D — all four. Tooling (A), certification (B), contract (C), redesigned workflows (D). Ignoring any one risks a failed migration — the point of "think holistically."

Q4 · Value / Utility / Warranty

A reporting service delivers exactly the reports the business needs, is highly available and secure, but the vendor recently raised prices sharply. Which statements are true? (select all that apply)

A. Utility is present.

B. Warranty is present.

C. Rising cost can still reduce perceived value.

D. Because utility and warranty are met, value cannot change.

Correct: A, B, C. D is wrong — value is **perceived** and weighs **costs and risks**; a price rise can lower perceived value even with good utility & warranty.

Q5 · Service Value Chain

To launch a new mobile feature: leadership sets direction, the team gathers customer needs, designs and releases it, and later reviews metrics to improve. Match the value-chain activities used. (select all that apply)

A. Plan (direction)

B. Engage (customer needs)

C. Design & Transition (design + release)

D. Improve (review metrics)

Correct: A, B, C, D. A clean illustration that value streams combine multiple activities — not a rigid line.

Q6 · Change types

Which of these are correctly classified? (select all that apply)

A. Resetting a password via a standard procedure → Standard change / service request handling.

B. An urgent patch for an active security breach → Emergency change.

C. A scheduled, assessed database upgrade → Normal change.

D. Every change must be approved by a full CAB.

Correct: A, B, C. D is wrong — ITIL 4 uses a **change authority** appropriate to the change; standard changes are pre-authorised and don't need per-instance CAB approval.

Q7 · Optimize & Automate

A manager proposes automating the current 14-step onboarding process immediately to "save time." What is the best ITIL 4 guidance? (select all that apply)

A. First optimise/simplify the process, then automate.

B. Automate first, tidy up later.

C. Remove steps that add no value before automating.

D. Keep human intervention only where it genuinely adds value.

Correct: A, C, D. B is the classic wrong answer — never automate a broken/bloated process.

Q8 · Practices in a support flow

A user calls the single point of contact to request a new laptop, and during the call also reports that email is down. Which practices are involved? (select all that apply)

A. Service Desk (the point of contact)

B. Service Request Management (new laptop)

C. Incident Management (email down)

D. Problem Management (mandatory for every incident)

Correct: A, B, C. D is wrong — problem management is *not* automatically invoked for every single incident; it's triggered to find root cause when warranted.

12 Rapid Revision Sheet last-hour cram

7 Guiding Principles 🔥🔥🔥

1. Focus on value
2. Start where you are
3. Progress iteratively with feedback
4. Collaborate & promote visibility
5. Think & work holistically
6. Keep it simple & practical
7. Optimize **and then** automate

Service Value Chain (6) 🔥🔥🔥

1. Plan
2. Improve
3. Engage
4. Design & Transition
5. Obtain / Build
6. Deliver & Support

Flexible model, not linear.

Four Dimensions 🔥🔥

1. Organizations & People (who)
2. Information & Technology (what with)
3. Partners & Suppliers (who helps)
4. Value Streams & Processes (how)

+ PESTLE external factors.

SVS components (5) 🔥🔥🔥

1. Guiding Principles
2. Governance
3. Service Value Chain
4. Practices
5. Continual Improvement

In: Opportunity+Demand → Out: Value.

Must-know practices 🔥🔥🔥 Incident (restore fast) · Problem (root cause) · Service Request (normal) · Service Desk (SPOC) · Change Enablement (risk/benefit) · SLM (targets) · Continual Improvement.

Definition triggers 🔥🔥🔥 Event = change of state · Incident = unplanned interruption · Problem = cause · Known error = analysed, unfixed · Workaround = reduces impact · CI = managed component · Value = perceived benefit (co-created).

Exam-day tactics for multi-answer scenarios:

- Read the **question stem last word first**: "which are **true / violated / involved**?"
- Evaluate **each option independently** as true/false — don't stop at the first correct one.
- Watch absolute words — "**always / every / must / cannot**" are usually the wrong options.
- When two options seem to overlap (e.g. Incident vs Problem), pick by **intent**: restore vs root-cause.
- Map the story to the **right layer**: principle? dimension? value-chain activity? practice?

Highest-yield final focus: the 7 Guiding Principles (applied), the 6 Value Chain activities, Incident vs Problem vs Change, Utility vs Warranty, and the four Dimensions. Nail these five and you clear 65% comfortably.

